

systems, including Windows and Mac. The Apache binary running under UNIX is called HTTPd (short for HTTP daemon), and under win32 is called Apache.exe.

In this tutorial, we will install Apache and PHP in Windows in order to run your system as localhost (server). The system prerequisites to do so are:

- Download and install Visual C++ redistributable 2015
- Download Apache24
- Download PHP 5.6

Downloading and installing Visual C++ redistributable 2015

Let's first install Visual C++ redistributable. The earlier packages like Visual C++ redistributable 2012 will give an error of a missing `vcruntime140.dll` file; so it would be better if the newer version, Visual C++ redistributable 2015, is installed, which will solve most of the issues. Most computers nowadays have it pre-installed. Nevertheless, I will lead readers through the step-by-step procedure of the installation.

First, download Visual C++ redistributable 2015 from the Windows official site.

Next, download the preferred version, i.e., if your system is 32-bit then download the x86 version, or download x64 for a 64-bit system. Proceed to install after the download is complete.

Installation wizard of Visual C++ redistributable 2015

Read the terms and conditions of the licence, click on the tick

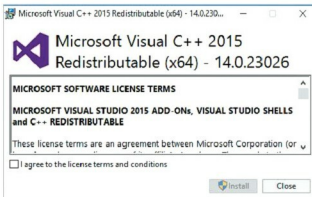


Figure 1: Visual C++ redistribution installation step 1

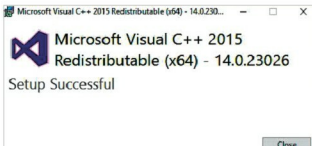


Figure 2: Visual C++ redistribution installation step 2

mark to accept these, and then click on Next.

Click on *Close* when the installation finishes.

Downloading and installing Apache

We can download the latest version of Apache from <https://www.apachelounge.com/download/>. Download it based on your system's requirements (32-bit or 64-bit).

Extract it and put it in the C:\ drive.

Downloading and installing PHP

Download PHP from <http://windows.php.net/download>. In the dropdown, *Binaries and Source Releases*, there will be many versions of PHP. The latest release is PHP 7, but I strongly suggest that you download PHP 5.6 because it is more common and will be installed in most of the servers and by the hosting services providers. You can use PHP 7 in the future but, as of now, we are coding something so we can continue with the PHP 5.6 thread safe release.

Download the Zip file and unzip it. Place it in a newly created folder named PHP inside the C:\ drive.

Running Apache and PHP in your system as localhost

Let's access the Apache24 folder that we moved to the C:\ drive earlier. Then, get into the *conf* folder and edit the *httpd.conf* file using Notepad or your favourite text editor.

Scroll down to the bottom of the file and add the following lines:

```
LoadModule PHP5_module "c:/PHP/PHP5apache2_4.dll"
AddHandler application/x-httpd-PHP .PHP
# configure the path to PHP.ini
PHPIniDir "C:/PHP"
```

Next, find *DirectoryIndex* (you can use *Ctrl+f*) and change *index.html* to *index.php*.

What we are doing here is telling Apache that the first file we need is a PHP file and not an HTML one. Save the changes.

Now, search for *ServerName* (*Ctrl+f*). Initially, it is commented; so uncomment it. We are changing this because we will use it for our browser search. Instead of

```
#
# DirectoryIndex: sets the file that Apache will serve if a dire
# is requested.
#IfModule dir_module>
    DirectoryIndex index.php
</IfModule>

#
# The following lines prevent .htaccess and .htpasswd files from
# viewed by Web clients.
#
<Files ".ht*">
```

Figure 3: Change in DirectoryIndex